

Aidan Ryder

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ABOUT ME

Design Engineering student at Imperial College London and Kitchener Scholar, with strengths in systems thinking, teamwork and prototyping. I am particularly drawn to complex, open-ended problems where I can research unfamiliar areas, connect ideas across disciplines and develop practical solutions with real-world impact.

EDUCATION

MEng Design Engineering

Imperial College London

2024 – Present
London

- **MODULE CONTENT:** Human Centred Design, Industrial Design (DFMA), UI/UX Design, Mechatronics, Sustainable Design, Systems Thinking, FEA and CFD.

SKILLS

Software

Figma, Fusion 360, Ansys Fluent, Ansys Static Structural, Ansys Modal, Overleaf, MATLAB, Visual Studios Code, Notion

Design

CAD, Circuit Design, Mechanical Design, Systems Design, Business Modelling, Branding, Human Centred Design

Soft Skills

Teamwork, Communication, Time Management, Presentation Skills,

PROJECTS

Airline Seat System Design

- **Group:** As a group we dismantled a commercial airline chair and talked to industry leaders about what an airline chair needs, the system behind building & selling the chair as a product and how this system might be changed or adjusted/improved upon to create a more economically, environmentally and socially sustainable product. This side of the project also helped me develop my teamwork skills, particularly through debating different ideas and reaching decisions in a productive way.
- **Individual:** This section was about condensing our knowledge into designing a new system and chair that would fit that system and discussing how it might be implemented into the current market.

Axis Pro

- **Group:** Developed and iteratively refined an electromechanical product for an underserved user group. The final design provided controlled vertical translation and rotational movement for precision painting, alongside packaging, branding and a project video.
- **CTO:** Led the electromechanical and Design for Manufacture and Assembly (DFMA) aspects of the project, reducing manufacturing time and cost through mechanical simplification and appropriate manufacturing methods. Developed leadership skills through Leading meetings, assigning tasks and helping manage the project direction.

Rhythm Rush

- **Group:** Gathered user data through interviews, observations and structured experiments to understand human behaviour in urban spaces and identify opportunities to increase urban play. Used these insights to develop a human-centred concept for situations where interaction with strangers is socially acceptable, resulting in a body-tracking dance game designed to encourage spontaneous social interaction.

WORK HISTORY

Paddington Robotics

- Assembled supermarket robots, discussed DFA choices and identified possible improvements. A build expected to take 3–4 weeks for a team of two was completed in 1 week through improved efficiency. The experience also taught me about the potential benefits of asymmetry in design.

06/2026
London

McDonalds

- Worked across multiple roles under high time pressure, often covering 2–3 roles during evening shifts. Trained newer employees to use equipment efficiently and safely.

08/2023 – 07/2024
Wirral

INTERESTS

Sports

Competed in half marathons, casual climbing and general gym/training.

Reading

Reading history books, classics, philosophy and fiction.

General

Riding motor bikes, playing chess and climbing mountains